maintaining Trump-era trade policies. With Trump back in office and escalating trade conflicts with a bevy of countries, the WTO faces an uphill battle, not only in addressing the structural issues that Trump has exposed but also in rebuilding trust and legitimacy among its members and constituents. Nonetheless, the organization's ability to adapt and endure offers hope for its continued role as a cornerstone of global trade governance.

8.8 UNFPA and Trump

The United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) operates in more than 150 countries, championing sexual and reproductive health and gender equality. Funded by voluntary member-state contributions, it has historically relied on substantial financial outlays from the United States, which is typically one of its largest donors.[77] The organization's staff comprises highly qualified professionals, including public health experts and economists, many of whom hold advanced degrees and elite credentials.

During Donald Trump's first presidency, the UNFPA became a prime target of his administration's ideological crusade to curtail US involvement in IOs and to reduce funding for initiatives linked to reproductive health. Trump's administration viewed the UNFPA as expendable, extending domestic Republican policies of cutting funds for abortion-related services to global health organizations. In 2017, the administration slashed $32.5 million in US contributions to the agency, citing its alleged support for coercive abortion practices in China, a claim the UNFPA vehemently denied.[78] Trump also demanded that the agency remove references to reproductive health from its communications regarding the COVID-19 response, fearing it might promote abortion as an essential service.[79]

Faced with this hostility, the UNFPA adopted several strategies to mitigate the damage. Anticipating potential funding cuts even before they were enacted, the organization proactively sought to diversify its donor base. It reached out to NGOs, charitable foundations, and both private-and public-sector partners, aiming to reduce its reliance on any single state's contributions (Hirschmann 2021). This diversification effort proved prescient, enabling the UNFPA to weather US funding cuts. By 2022, the